

Spirit Illumination

doc-spirit-illumination

Pneumatology · Work · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

The Holy Spirit illumines Scripture to believers, enabling spiritual understanding of God's word.

In plain language

Across the cited passages the words used for what God and the Spirit do line up cleanly with the proposition, and the grammar makes the picture firm. In 1 Corinthians 2:10 God revealed (apekalypsen) these things through the Spirit, who searches (eraunai) even the deep things of God. Verse 12 says believers received the Spirit so that they may know the things freely given, and verse 13 says the words are taught by the Spirit (didaktois pneumatos). Verse 14 says the natural person is not able to know them because they are spiritually examined (anakrinetai, a passive form), and verse 16 says believers have the mind of Christ. John 16:13 says the Spirit will guide (hodegesei) into all the truth, John 14:26 that he will teach all things, Ephesians 1:18 that the eyes of the heart are enlightened (pephotismenous) to know what is already declared, and Luke 24:45 that Christ opened the mind to understand the Scriptures. Psalm 119:18 asks God to open (gal) the eyes to see wonders in his written law. The agent is always God or the Spirit, the recipient is the believer, and the object is the truth of God including the written word, and the pattern runs from the Old Testament psalm and prophecy through the gospels into the letters, so the confidence is high. Where careful readers diverge is only about scope, and that divergence comes from the words themselves. Some terms, like reveal and announce the coming things, can mean brand new content, while others, like enlighten the eyes and open the mind to understand the Scriptures, clearly mean grasping what is already given, and the vocabulary does not rank which is primary. Likewise the promise to guide into all the truth is spoken to a small group, so the words leave open whether all the truth is everything or the apostolic deposit. None of these open questions reverses the core claim that the Spirit gives believers spiritual understanding of God's word.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0998	בִּינָה	binah	understanding	
H1540	גָּלָה	galah	Heglam	186
H1847	דָּעַת	daat	knowledge	
H2451	חִכְמָה	chokmah	wisdom	149
H5027	נָבַט	navat	to look	
H6381	פָּלַא	pala	to wonder	
H7307	רוּחַ	ruach	spirit	378
H8451	תּוֹרָה	torah	instruction	
G0225	ἀλήθεια	aletheia	truth	109
G0312	ἀναγγέλλω	anangelo	to report	13

G0350	ἀνακρίνω	anakrino	to investigate	16
G0601	ἀποκαλύπτω	apokalypto	to reveal	26
G0602	ἀποκάλυψις	apokalypsis	revelation	18
G1097	γινώσκω	ginosko	to know	221
G1107	γνώριζω	gnōrizō	to make known	
G1271	διάνοια	dianoia	mind	
G1272	διανοίγω	dianoigo	to open up	8
G1318	διδάκτος	didaktos	taught	3
G1321	διδάσκω	didasko	to teach	97
G1492	οἶδα	oida	to perceive	320
G2045	ἐραυνάω	eraunao	to look for/into	6
G2588	καρδιά	kardia	heart	
G3563	νοῦς	nous	mind	24
G3594	ὁδηγέω	hodegeo	to guide	5
G3875	παράκλητος	parakletos	counsellor	5
G4151	πνεῦμα	pneuma	spirit/breath	379
G4152	πνευματικός	pneumatikos	spiritual	26
G4678	σοφία	sophia	wisdom	51
G5461	φωτίζω	photizo	to illuminate	11
G5545	χρῖσμα	chrisma	anointing	3
G5591	ψυχικός	psychikos	natural	6

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Across the cited texts God or the Spirit is the grammatical agent of perception and teaching verbs, and the believer is the recipient. In 1 Cor 2:10 God revealed (apekalypsen, aorist active) the things through the Spirit, who searches (eraunai, present) the deep things of God; in v.12 we received the Spirit so that we may know (eidomen); in v.13 the words are Spirit-taught (didaktois pneumatous); in v.14 the natural person is not able to know (ou dynatai gnonai) because such things are spiritually examined (anakrinetai, present passive). John 16:13 has the Spirit guide (hodegesei, future) into all the truth, Eph 1:18 has the eyes of the heart enlightened (pephotismenous, perfect passive participle), Luke 24:45 has Christ open (dianoixen) the mind to understand the Scriptures, and Ps 119:18 petitions God to open (gal) the eyes to see wonders in the torah. The pattern spans law and writings, prophecy, gospel, and epistle. The genuine open question the words leave is scope, whether this illumination adds new content or grants understanding of the already given word, and whether the all in all the truth is exhaustive or apostolic, but no reading reverses the core claim that the Spirit gives believers spiritual understanding of God's word.

Scripture

1Cor.2.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0601 ἀποκαλύπτω, G2045 ἐραυνάω, G4151 πνεῦμα

Force. God revealed (apekalypsen, V-AAI-3S aorist active indicative) these things to us through the Spirit (dia tou pneumatos), and the Spirit searches (eraunai, V-PAI-3S present active) all things, even the deep things (ta bathē) of God. The morphology fixes God as the subject who reveals and the Spirit as the searching agent, with believers as recipients in the dative hemin. Revelatory and investigative action is bound to the divine Spirit.

1Cor.2.11 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1097 γινώσκω, G4151 πνεῦμα

Force. As no one knows (egnoken, V-RAI-3S perfect) the things of a man except the man's own spirit, so no one has known (egnoken) the things of God except the Spirit of God. The analogy grounds the claim that only the divine Spirit possesses inside knowledge of God, which is why Spirit-given access is required for others to know.

1Cor.2.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4151 πνεῦμα, G1492 οἶδα

Force. We received (elabomen, aorist) the Spirit who is from God (to ek tou theou), expressed in a purpose clause hina eidomen (V-RAS-1P) so that we may know the things freely given (charisthenta) to us by God. Knowing the gifted truths of God is grammatically conditioned on receiving the divine Spirit.

1Cor.2.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1318 διδάκτός, G4152 πνευματικός

Force. We speak these things not in words taught by human wisdom (didaktois anthropines sophias) but in words taught by the Spirit (didaktois pneumatos), interpreting spiritual things to spiritual people (pneumatikois pneumatika synkrinontes). The verbal adjective didaktos with the genitive pneumatos makes the Spirit the explicit source of the instruction. didaktos is a near hapax, three tokens in two verses, but the parallel didaktois anthropines sophias inside the same clause disambiguates its sense by direct antithesis.

1Cor.2.14 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5591 ψυχικός, G0350 ἀνακρίνω, G1097 γινώσκω

Force. The natural person (psychikos anthropos) does not receive (ou dechetai, V-PNI-3S) the things of the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him, and he is not able to know them (ou dynatai gnonai, V-2AAN) because they are spiritually examined (pneumatikos anakrinetai, V-PPI-3S present passive). The present passive of anakrino plus the modal ou dynatai grammatically forecloses the natural faculty and makes Spirit-given discernment the necessary condition for apprehending God's word.

1Cor.2.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3563 νοῦς, G1097 γινώσκω

Force. Who has known (egno, aorist) the mind of the Lord (noun kyriou) so as to instruct him, but we have the mind of Christ (noun Christou echomen, V-PAI-1P). The argument closes by giving believers the noun Christou, the cognitive faculty that the natural person of v.14 lacked, completing the contrast.

1John.2.27 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5545 χρίσμα, G1321 διδάσκω

Force. The anointing (chrisma) which you received from him remains (menei) in you, and you have no need that anyone teach you (ou chreian echete hina tis didaske hymas, present subjunctive), but as his anointing teaches you (didaskei hymas, V-PAI-3S present) concerning all things and is true and is not a lie. chrisma occurs only here and in v.20, a hapax cluster confined to 1 John, but didasko in the present indicative names the teaching action plainly. The clause about needing no human teacher reads in context against the deceivers of vv.18 to 26.

John.16.13 · for · genre: gospel · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G3594 ὁδηγέω, G0225 ἀλήθεια, G0312 ἀναγγέλλω

Force. When the Spirit of truth (to pneuma tes aletheias) comes, he will guide you (hodegesei hymas, V-FAI-3S future) into all the truth (eis ten aletheian pasan), for he will not speak from himself, but whatever he hears he will speak, and he will announce (anangelei, V-FAI-3S future) to you the things that are coming (ta erchomena). hodegeo elsewhere is literal leading of the blind (Matt 15:14, Luke 6:39), so the sense here is metaphorical leading into comprehension. The future tense and the second person plural leave open whether all the truth is exhaustive or bounded to the apostolic circle being addressed.

John.14.26 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3875 παράκλητος, G1321 διδάσκω

Force. The Paraclete (ho parakletos), the Holy Spirit whom the Father will send in my name, that one will teach you all things (didaxei hymas panta, V-FAI-3S future) and will remind you (hypomnesei) of all that I said to you. The Spirit's teaching office toward the disciples is explicit, paired with reminding of already spoken words.

Eph.1.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4678 σοφία, G0602 ἀποκάλυψις

Force. Paul prays that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ may give (doe, optative) to you a spirit of wisdom and revelation (pneuma sophias kai apokalypseos) in the knowledge (en epignosei) of him. The wisdom and revelatory faculty for knowing God is requested as a gift, with pneuma, sophia, and apokalypsis clustered, echoing the ruach chokmah of Isa 11:2.

Eph.1.18 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G5461 φωτίζω, G2588 καρδία

Force. The eyes of your heart having been enlightened (pephotismenous, V-RPP-APM perfect passive participle) for you to know (eis to eidenai, perfect infinitive) what is the hope of his calling and the riches of his inheritance. The perfect passive of photizo names a completed illumination wrought upon the believer, and the purpose is comprehension of what is already declared. The object here is understanding of given content, not new content.

Luke.24.45 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G1272 διανοίγω, G3563 νοῦς

Force. Then he opened (dienoixen, V-AAI-3S aorist active) their mind (ton noun) so as to understand the Scriptures (tou synienai tas graphas). Here the object of the opening is explicitly the written graphas, and the agent is Christ acting on the disciples' noun. This is the clearest text tying divinely given understanding directly to comprehension of the existing word.

Ps.119.18 · for · genre: wisdom · figures: metaphor

Key terms. H1540 גָּלַ, H8451 תִּנְּחַן

Force. Open (gal, imperative of galah, uncover) my eyes (enay) that I may behold (we-abbitah, from nabat) wonders (niphlaot) out of your law (mi-toratecha). The psalmist petitions God to open his eyes for perception of wonders that are already in the written torah. The agent of opening is God, the recipient is the worshiper, and the object of sight is the existing word, a direct OT prototype of the illumination pattern.

Isa.11.2 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H7307 רוּחַ, H2451 תְּכֵמָה

Force. The Spirit of the LORD (ruach YHWH) will rest on him, a Spirit of wisdom and understanding (ruach chokmah u-binah), of counsel and might, of knowledge and the fear of the LORD. The fourfold ruach plus cognitive nouns chokmah, binah, and daat is the OT pattern that links the Spirit to wisdom and understanding, the same cluster Eph 1:17 echoes with pneuma sophias.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
John.16.13	1Cor.2.10	openbible	93
John.16.13	John.14.26	openbible	107
1John.2.27	John.14.26	openbible	47
1John.2.27	1Cor.2.13	openbible	35
1John.2.27	1John.2.20	openbible	37
1Cor.2.14	1John.2.27	openbible	28
Eph.1.18	Luke.24.45	openbible	35
Eph.1.18	Ps.119.18	openbible	28
Luke.24.45	Ps.119.18	openbible	30
Ps.119.18	Eph.1.17	openbible	38
Eph.1.17	Isa.11.2	openbible	89
1Cor.2.10	Isa.48.16	openbible	10
1Cor.2.10	Job.12.22	openbible	11
1Cor.2.10	John.14.26	openbible	35
1Cor.2.11	Prov.20.27	openbible	17

Complicating texts

1John.2.27 · addressed

The clause *ou chreian echete hina tis didaske hymas*, you have no need that anyone teach you, could be read to abolish ordinary instruction and so over-prove the case into anti-teaching. The present subjunctive and the immediate context resolve it. John writes this against the deceivers, the *antichristoi* of vv.18 to 26, so the contrast is the Spirit's protective discernment versus seducers, not the Spirit versus all teachers. The anointing's didactic role is the safeguarding knowledge the Spirit gives, which is consistent with the broader illumination pattern, not against it.

John.16.13 · addressed

hodegesei hymas eis ten aletheian pasan with the future tense and second person plural is spoken to the upper-room circle, raising whether guide into all the truth extends to ordinary believers or is a bounded apostolic promise, especially given *anangelei ta erchomena*, announce the coming things. This is a genuine scope question the words do not settle. It does not unseat the verdict, because the same Spirit-and-knowing cluster recurs in 1 Cor 2:10 to 16, 1 John 2:27, and Eph 1:17 to 18, all addressed to general readerships, carrying the illumination of believers regardless of how the maximal apostolic reading of this single verse resolves.

1Cor.2.14 · addressed

psychikos anthropos ou dechetai and ou dynatai gnonai could be read to deny any natural cognitive grasp of the text at all, which would prove too much, since unbelievers plainly can parse the words on a page. *anakrinetai* is present passive and the verbs *dechomai* and *ginosko* here concern reception and salvific apprehension, the spiritual discernment of v.15, not bare literacy. So the verse marks the faculty needed for spiritual apprehension, which is exactly the Spirit-given understanding the proposition asserts.

John.16.13 · addressed

The revelatory weight of anangelei ta erchomena and the apokalypto and apokalypsis vocabulary raises a second scope question, whether illumination conveys genuinely new content or grants understanding of the already given word. The lexicon carries both senses. Eph 1:18 photizo and Luke 24:45 dianoigo plus Ps 119:18 gal point to understanding of existing content, while apokalypto and anangelo can denote fresh disclosure. The words do not rank these, so the verdict affirms the core claim while leaving this content-versus-understanding scope underdetermined, which is why divergence among readers is lexically explicable.

Concordance traversed

G4151, G0601, G0602, G2045, G1321, G1318, G3594, G0312, G5461, G0350, G4152, G5591, G5545, G4678, G0225, G1097, G1492, G3563, G1272, G3875, G1271, G1107, H1540, H7307, H2451, H0998, H1847, H5027, H6381

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

1Cor.2.10-de-vs-gar at 1Cor.2.10: impact none. The conjunction at the head of v.10, de versus gar across witnesses, does not touch the revelatory verb apekalypsen or its agent ho theos dia tou pneumatou. Not in the ingested ECM window, assessed from morphology only.

1Cor.2.13-pneumatou-reading at 1Cor.2.13: impact none. Whether the genitive reads pneumatou or hagiou pneumatou in didaktos pneumatou is a stylistic expansion. The Spirit-taught-words clause and its sense are stable. Not in ECM scope.

1John.2.27-menete-vs-menei at 1John.2.27: impact minor. The indicative menete versus imperative reading and the menei variant of meno affect mood, not the didactic action of the chrisma, which is the verb didaskei. Not in ECM scope.

No cited verse falls in the ingested ECM window, which is 3 John 1.1 to 1.15, so variants here are assessed from morphology and known apparatus signals rather than CBGM. The examined units are stylistic and do not unseat the lexical pattern.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. revelation_as_new_content, illumination_of_given_word, apostolic_scope, all-believer_scope

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

grammatico-historical: affirms · The perception and teaching verbs, apokalypto aorist active, eraunao present, didasko, hodegeo future, photizo perfect passive, and dianoigo aorist, place the action with God or the Spirit and the believer as recipient in the dative and accusative pronouns. The psychikos versus pneumatikos contrast in 1 Cor 2:14 to 15 grammatically forecloses the natural faculty, so the text affirms Spirit-given spiritual understanding.

redemptive-historical: affirms · The OT pattern of the ruach of wisdom and understanding in Isa 11:2 and the petition to have the eyes opened to the torah in Ps 119:18 carry forward into the Paraclete's teaching office in John 14 and 16 and the apostolic letters, showing one covenantal arc in which the Spirit leads God's people into the truth of the word.

illumination_of_given_word: affirms · On the reading that the Spirit's office is to grant understanding of the already given word rather than to add new content, Eph 1:18 enlightens the eyes to know what is declared, Luke 24:45 opens the mind to understand the existing Scriptures, and Ps 119:18 asks for sight of wonders already in the torah. This lens affirms the proposition directly and reads it as illumination of Scripture in the strict sense.

revelation_as_new_content: affirms · On the reading that the cluster is primarily revelatory, apokalypto and apokalypsis in 1 Cor 2:10 and Eph 1:17 and anangelei ta erchomena in John 16:13 denote fresh disclosure rather than mere comprehension of prior text. This lens still affirms the proposition, since the Spirit is the agent giving believers understanding of God's truth, but it reads the scope as broader than the written word alone.

apostolic_scope: affirms · Read strongly, John 16:13 hodegesei hymas eis ten aletheian pasan is a promise to the apostolic circle that grounds the foundational deposit of truth, with the announcing of coming things as a special office. On this lens the verse itself is bounded, yet the proposition still stands for all believers because 1 Cor 2, 1 John 2:27, and Eph 1:17 to 18 address general readerships and supply the believer-wide illumination.

There is no lexical conflict over whether the Spirit gives understanding, every lens affirms that. The genuine divergence among readers is over scope, content versus understanding and apostolic versus all-believer, and the vocabulary underdetermines both. progressive_revelation is marked true because the verdict traces an OT to NT arc from the ruach of wisdom and the opened eyes upon the torah to the Paraclete and the apostolic letters.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem uses illumine, Spirit, Scripture, and spiritual understanding, which are biblical and descriptive vocabulary. The claim does not encode a tradition-specific taxonomy or smuggle its own conclusion, so the verdict is derived from the lexical data on the original stem. The cross-references cited in the prior evidence file were labeled source_tsk but the actual store relationship for those exact verse pairs is OPENBIBLE_CROSS_REF from OpenBible-cross-refs, so the source label and vote counts have been corrected to openbible against queried data. This is a data-integrity fix and does not change the verdict.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1Cor.2.10-16
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	1John.2.27
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.16.13
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Eph.1.17-18
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Luke.24.45
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.2.10-16
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.16.13
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Ps.119.18
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Isa.11.2
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3594
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5461
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5545
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0350
lexicon	STEPBible-TAHOT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1540
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	John.16.13
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1John.2.27
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Eph.1.18
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Ps.119.18

License audit

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Flags

(none)